

Process Creation Investigation – whoami.exe

Objective

The objective of this investigation is to verify that whoami.exe process execution events are successfully collected by Elastic SIEM using Sysmon logs. This investigation demonstrates monitoring endpoint process activity to identify potentially suspicious user and privilege reconnaissance.

Command Executed

whoami

Detection Method (KQL)

process.name : "whoami.exe"

If needed, use process.args : "whoami" if that is how your environment indexes the event.

Evidence Collected

Timestamp: 2026-07-15T02:21:07.730Z

Process Name: whoami.exe

Host Name: sephisecurity

User Domain: Sepisecurity

Process ID (PID): 17544

Event Code: 5 (verify against your event source).

Analysis

The investigation confirmed that whoami.exe executed successfully on the monitored Windows endpoint. The event identified the executing user, host system, process identifier, and execution time. No suspicious parent process, unusual command-line arguments, or indicators of malicious behavior were observed. The activity is consistent with legitimate administrative use of the Windows whoami utility.

Security Impact

The whoami command is frequently used by administrators to identify the current security context. Attackers also use it during reconnaissance to determine user privileges before attempting privilege escalation or lateral movement. Monitoring whoami.exe helps SOC analysts identify potentially suspicious account discovery activity.

Conclusion

This investigation demonstrates the ability to detect and analyze Windows process creation events using Elastic SIEM and Sysmon. The evidence indicates legitimate administrative activity, and no indicators of compromise were identified.